

SANDBOX

PLAYSTYLE TOOLKIT:

THE CITY



KRI PUBLISHING AND SEIDMANN GAMES

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CREDITS

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INTRODUCTION

As both fans and good friends of Karl Otto, we really enjoyed his West Marches Playstyle Guidebook. Many readers, ourselves included, felt that it needed some solid roll tables to go along with it.

In our experience, improvisation becomes much easier when you have a few tables within arm's reach. Knowing you have something to fall back on gives you the confidence to create freely in the moment.

We at Seidmann Games approached Karl Otto with the idea of designing a companion book to his West Marches guidebook, but as often happens, the project evolved into a trilogy. One book would have required too many compromises.

WHAT IS SANDBOX-STYLE PLAY?

At its core, sandbox play means that both the GM and the players are free to follow their own interests rather than a predetermined story. It is the opposite of railroading. Neither the players nor the GM knows beforehand where the campaign will end up. It is fair to say that many play sandbox campaigns without using the term or being aware of it.

How much of the setting has been prepared before the campaign begins is largely irrelevant. In a sandbox the players are free to explore, experiment, and pursue their own goals within the campaign world.

HOW TO USE THE SANDBOX BOOKS

The terms West Marches, hexcrawl, and sandbox are often used interchangeably when discussing old-school play, but they are not the same thing.

- Hexcrawling is a procedure that supports sandbox-style play.
- West Marches is a campaign structure designed for sandbox-style play.

While sandbox campaigns can certainly use either or both of these approaches, neither is required. A sandbox is defined by player freedom and open-ended exploration, not by any particular procedure or campaign framework.

- You can use these books as companion books when you apply the procedures from the West Marches Campaign Playstyle books or the Hexcrawl Playstyle books.
- These books can be used to generate playable content before or during your sessions, regardless of whether you use the Hexcrawl or West Marches structure.

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1. THE GENERAL DETAILS

WHY THE CITY FIRST?

We chose to begin with the city book because both West Marches and hexcrawl campaigns tend to devote little attention to the home base. Yet cities are sandboxes in their own right, filled with opportunities for adventure. Political intrigue, shady dealings in dark alleys, forbidden romances, and turf wars can all unfold within the city walls.

Since the other KR1 books leave the city open to interpretation, we hope this book will help you quickly generate the details you need, allowing you to focus on the wilderness and the dungeons beyond the city walls.

ROLL TABLES

The tables in this book are designed with West Marches and hexcrawl campaigns in mind. There are certainly other resources that delve deeper into the minutiae and provide tables for every conceivable detail, but our goal was to keep this book lean and practical. We wanted a tool you can quickly reference at the table, without having to sift through pages of material you'll rarely use.

WHAT'S NEXT?

The next two books in this series will cover the Wilderness and the Dungeons, providing the same level of support for exploration beyond the city. Keep an eye out for those releases. We're giving them a little more time in the oven to ensure they are every bit as detailed and useful as this one.

THE GENERAL DETAILS

This first chapter takes an eagle's-eye view of the city, much like the picture to the left. The tables presented on the following pages are used to generate an overview of your city, helping you identify the major power players and notable features when summarising the city to others for the first time.

A CITY IN A JIFFY

You are free to use the tables in this book in any order you like, but if you want a recipe to follow, we suggest the steps below. You will need all the d20s and d6s you have in your dice bag, a pencil, and a sheet of paper.

STEP 1: BASICS

Go to **Table A (City Type)** and roll 1d20 on either the common or uncommon table to determine the type of settlement you're creating. For a home base, we recommend using the common table, while the uncommon table is better suited for cities the party encounters during their travels. Roll or choose a name with **Table B (City Name)**.

On the next table, **Table C (Special Features)**, roll 2d20 and choose one feature within the town and one in the surrounding area. Then roll on **Table D (City Governance)**.

STEP 2: DROP DICE FOR BUILDINGS

Grab a handful of d20s and drop them onto a piece of paper. We recommend 5 dice for small towns and hamlets, 10 dice for small cities, and 20 for large cities or metropolises. Wherever a die lands, place a building. The number rolled corresponds to an entry on **Table E (Buildings)**. You can choose building types from either column, but keep in mind that smaller settlements will have fewer entries from the right-hand column.

Depending on the type of governance you've rolled or chosen, you may want to reserve space for a castle, palace, or walled district. You can determine its location with a dice drop as well. If the settlement is located by water, leave room for a waterline and a dock.

Keep a legend in the corner of your map or on a separate sheet of paper.

STEP 3: EAT, PRAY, AND QUEST

If you haven't rolled a tavern, an adventurers' guild, or a temple, drop a few additional dice to determine where they are located. These are essential for most home bases, so make sure your town has them. You can flesh these out by visiting their respective chapters in the book.

STEP 4: HOMES

Drop 10–20 d6s to determine where people live in your city. The number rolled indicates how many houses are clustered together at that location. Alternatively, you can let the number represent the size of the dwelling. A 1 suggests a small house or hut, while a 6 indicates a lavish mansion or farmstead.

STEP 5: NOBLE HOUSES

We recommend having at least two noble houses operating in your city. A bit of rivalry makes for exciting drama. Roll on **Table F (Noble House Names)** and **Table G (House Details)** to detail them, then determine their base of operations by either choosing from the homes or buildings already drawn on the map, or by dropping some dice to find out where they are located.

STEP 6: STREETS

Now that all the buildings are in place, draw lines in between them to create streets. You can name them using **Table H (Street Names)**.

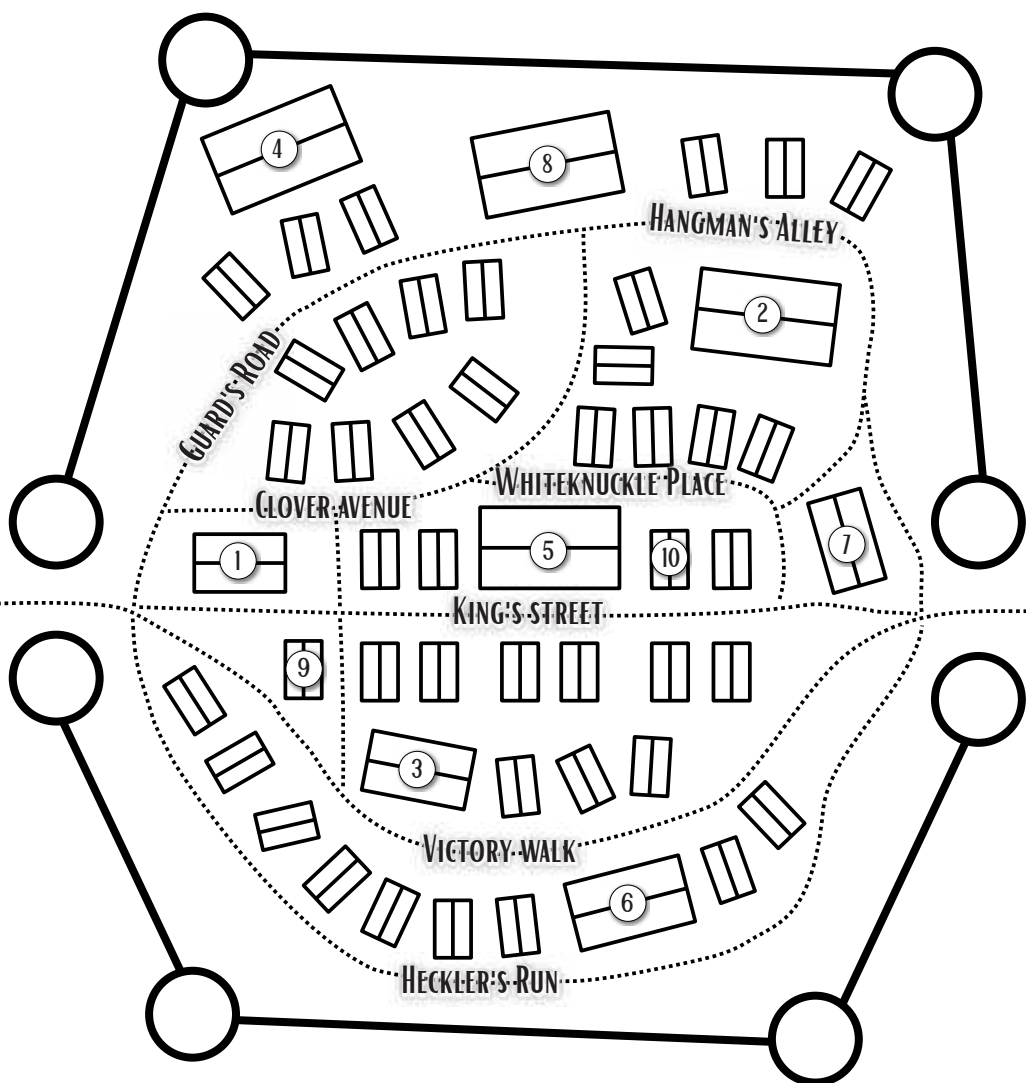
STEP 7: CITY WALLS

Not every city has a fortified wall around it, but if yours does, draw a line around all the buildings you've mapped so far, remembering to leave at least one opening for a main gate. Most cities have more than one gate. If the gate has guard towers, they are usually located at the corners of the walls. You can draw these as circles.

STEP 8: FURTHER DETAILS

Now that you have a map and the general details of your city, you can add as much detail as you like using the tables in the other chapters of this book. Be sure to leave room for your own ideas as well, and don't rely solely on our tables.

EXAMPLE CITY



EXAMPLE CITY

Here's an example city created using the various tools in this book. You can easily generate something similar, or if you prefer, use this as a starting point for your own city. There are a lot of buildings here to flesh out and detail.

CITY TYPE: Forest Village

CITY NAME: Kingsfall

SPECIAL FEATURES: Ringed by a crumbling wall, A dark pine forest

TOWN GOVERNANCE: Military commander

NOBLE HOUSES: Stormgrave (Arcane relics), Emberbane (Salt caverns)

LEGEND

1. **TAVERN:** The Angry Stag
2. **ADVENTURER'S GUILD:** The Azure Fellowship
3. **TEMPLE:** Order of the Radiant Dawn
4. **GUARD BARRACKS**
5. **TOWN HALL**
6. **NOBLE MANOR:** Stormgrave
7. **NOBLE HOUSE:** Emberbane
8. **BREWERY**
9. **GENERAL STORE**
10. **ALCHEMIST'S SHOP**

Λ. CITY TYPE

The first printed sandbox campaign used a borderland fort as its safe haven, but that's far from your only option. Roll or choose from the options below to determine the type of settlement for your players to begin their adventure. The table of uncommon types is intended for more adventurous GMs. The result may also influence where the settlement should be placed on your world map (covered in the upcoming Sandbox Playstyle Toolkit: The Wilderness).

D20 COMMON

- 1 Borderland fort
- 2 Cozy hamlet
- 3 Bustling metropolis
- 4 Port town
- 5 Swamp community
- 6 Mountain stronghold
- 7 Forest village
- 8 Military garrison town
- 9 River trade hub
- 10 Mining town
- 11 Pilgrimage site
- 12 Frontier outpost
- 13 Walled market city
- 14 Ruined city (partially inhabited)
- 15 Crossroads town
- 16 Island settlement
- 17 Cliffside town
- 18 Hidden valley refuge
- 19 Academic enclave
- 20 Theocratic city-state

D20 UNCOMMON

- 1 Floating lake town
- 2 Tree-top settlement
- 3 Crater town
- 4 Volcanic caldera town
- 5 Great bridge city
- 6 Salt flat settlement
- 7 Glacier outpost
- 8 Canyon shelf town
- 9 Sinkhole settlement
- 10 Floodplain stilt town
- 11 Ancient road waypoint
- 12 Collapsed dungeon town
- 13 Giant statue settlement
- 14 Great dam town
- 15 Astronomers' observatory town
- 16 Arcane experiment colony
- 17 Monster-hunter lodge town
- 18 Beast-taming enclave
- 19 Exile colony
- 20 Treasure-hunter boomtown

B. CITY NAME

There are many ways to create names for fantasy towns. Early TTRPG designers often borrowed real-world names and altered them slightly. You can also browse foreign words, change a few letters, and combine them to create something new. We provide two tables to help you generate classic-sounding town names: one with common prefixes and one with rarer ones. We encourage you to include at least one or two settlements with truly strange names born entirely from your own imagination.

D20	PREFIX (COMMON)	D20	PREFIX (RARE)	D20	SUFFIX
1	Raven	1	Strange	1	-haven
2	Wolf	2	Thistle	2	-ford
3	Iron	3	Dread	3	-dale
4	Oak	4	Hollow	4	-keep
5	Black	5	Molten	5	-watch
6	White	6	Wight	6	-hold
7	Red	7	Thunder	7	-bridge
8	Stone	8	Whole	8	-stead
9	Frost	9	Curse	9	-gate
10	Thorn	10	Skull	10	-port
11	Ashen	11	Udder	11	-crest
12	Silver	12	Dead man's	12	-rock
13	Gold	13	Black bear's	13	-moor
14	Shadow	14	Haunt	14	-fall
15	Storm	15	Kings	15	-ridge
16	Green	16	Queens	16	-field
17	Bright	17	Bovine	17	-cross
18	Deep	18	Feline	18	-brook
19	High	19	Hammers	19	-hollow
20	Dragon	20	Dust	20	-heim

C. SPECIAL FEATURES

Now that you have defined the type of town, it is time to consider the surrounding terrain and any special features that make the place stand out. Unique landmarks or notable structures help give the settlement character and make it memorable to the players. These features can also shape daily life and provide natural adventure hooks for the campaign.

D20 IN TOWN

- 1 Built on ancient ruins
- 2 Dominated by a great tower
- 3 Split by a deep chasm
- 4 Ringed by a crumbling wall
- 5 Wooden walkways above streets
- 6 Shrouded in constant mist
- 7 Built on layered terraces
- 8 Centered on a sacred tree
- 9 Tunnels beneath the streets
- 10 Built above a vast cistern
- 11 Dusted with falling ash
- 12 Runes carved into buildings
- 13 Built from salvaged materials
- 14 Lit by ever-burning lanterns
- 15 Protected by a magic barrier
- 16 Scarred by a huge crater
- 17 A dry fountain in the square
- 18 Rope bridges over alleys
- 19 Slowly sinking foundations
- 20 Crooked and uneven streets

D20 IN SURROUNDINGS

- 1 Ruined watchtower nearby
- 2 Ancient barrow mounds
- 3 A dark pine forest
- 4 A deep ravine
- 5 A haunted battlefield
- 6 Standing stones on a hill
- 7 A marsh of black reeds
- 8 A lonely stone bridge
- 9 An abandoned quarry
- 10 A sacred spring
- 11 A burned forest
- 12 A winding canyon
- 13 A waterfall and hidden cave
- 14 A collapsed mine
- 15 An eerie monastery ruin
- 16 A broken statue in the fields
- 17 A lake that glows at night
- 18 A hill crowned by gallows
- 19 A shrine to a forgotten god
- 20 A giant fallen tree

D. CITY GOVERNANCE

To flesh out your hometown, it helps to decide who runs it. Depending on your larger setting, you may need to reroll or choose an option that fits. Once you've determined who holds power and how the town is governed, you can roll to see what the people think of their rulers. Public opinion can add tension and provide hooks for future adventures.

D20 GOVERNANCE

- 1 Council of Elders
- 2 Baron or Baroness
- 3 King or Queen
- 4 Emperor or Empress
- 5 Anarchy (no formal leadership)
- 6 Merchant Council
- 7 Guild Consortium
- 8 Mayor and Town Council
- 9 Military Commander
- 10 Religious Authority
- 11 Mage Council
- 12 Theocratic Prophet
- 13 Rotating Leadership
- 14 Clan Assembly
- 15 Feudal Steward
- 16 Crime Syndicate
- 17 Popular Assembly
- 18 Magistrate or Judge
- 19 Corporate Charter
- 20 Hero-Protector

D20 WHAT DO THE PEOPLE THINK

- 1 Beloved by the people
- 2 Weak and indecisive
- 3 Out of touch
- 4 Feared more than loved
- 5 Too soft on crime
- 6 Widely admired
- 7 Easily swayed
- 8 Blind to problems
- 9 Holding the town together
- 10 Puppet for other powerplayers
- 11 Cruel and unforgiving
- 12 Keeps the peace
- 13 Prone to favoritism
- 14 Greedy for coin
- 15 Worshipped as a god
- 16 Bold in crisis
- 17 Rules by tradition
- 18 Favours old families
- 19 Favours the guilds
- 20 Barely tolerated

E. BUILDINGS

A town is the sum of its parts. Roll or pick what kind of building the town has at the start of the game. Before you continue, be sure to have somewhere to carouse, somewhere to get new quests, a shop or two, and a place to heal. The amount of buildings your home town has, depends on its size. A small hamlet will likely only have the bare essentials from the common list, while a bustling metropolis might offer most of what appears in both tables. Some entries might not suit your city-type at all. Don't be afraid to reroll.

D20 COMMON

- 1 Bakery
- 2 Blacksmith
- 3 Cemetery
- 4 Shrine
- 5 Stable
- 6 Market square
- 7 Mill
- 8 Healer's house
- 9 Jail
- 10 Inn
- 11 General store
- 12 Guard barracks
- 13 Butcher
- 14 Guild hall
- 15 Dock or harbor office
- 16 Tavern
- 17 Temple
- 18 Town hall
- 19 Warehouse
- 20 Watchtower

D20 LESS COMMON

- 1 Granary
- 2 Scribe or scrivener
- 3 Alchemist's shop
- 4 Bathhouse
- 5 Brewery
- 6 Brothel
- 7 Court or magistrate's hall
- 8 Fishmonger
- 9 Herbalist
- 10 Leather worker
- 11 Library
- 12 Moneylender
- 13 Noble manor
- 14 Tanner
- 15 Wizard's tower
- 16 Mason's yard
- 17 Schoolhouse
- 18 Carpenter's workshop
- 19 Orphanage
- 20 Tailor

F. NOBLE HOUSE NAMES

The noble houses are often the *de facto* rulers of a city. Their lineage and wealth can shape local politics much like commercial interests lobby in the modern world. Their names tend to be bold and brazen, designed to be memorable, either inspiring awe in common folk who aspire to rise into their ranks, or resentment strong enough to fuel conspiracies against them. A city should have at least two noble houses for rivalries to unfold.

D20 PREFIX

- | | |
|----|--------|
| 1 | Strong |
| 2 | Honor |
| 3 | Storm |
| 4 | Silver |
| 5 | Gold |
| 6 | Flight |
| 7 | Stout |
| 8 | Swift |
| 9 | Thorn |
| 10 | Wilde |
| 11 | Lion |
| 12 | Moon |
| 13 | Reign |
| 14 | Dawn |
| 15 | Dusk |
| 16 | Frost |
| 17 | Ember |
| 18 | High |
| 19 | Grim |
| 20 | Iron |

D20 SUFFIX

- | | |
|----|----------|
| 1 | - borne |
| 2 | - wood |
| 3 | - vale |
| 4 | - helm |
| 5 | - grave |
| 6 | - ward |
| 7 | - crow |
| 8 | - fellow |
| 9 | - hart |
| 10 | - crag |
| 11 | - blood |
| 12 | - bane |
| 13 | - field |
| 14 | - moor |
| 15 | - wright |
| 16 | - brand |
| 17 | - fell |
| 18 | - hammer |
| 19 | - glen |
| 20 | - mere |

G. HOUSE DETAILS

Noble houses rise to prominence through the accumulation of great wealth, whether through conquest, trade, divine favor, or more obscure and forbidden means. Roll for the House's source of wealth and their current goal. If the players interact with the house, they might be sent on a quest that aligns with both the house's source of wealth and their current goal.

D20 SOURCE OF WEALTH

- 1 Iron mines
- 2 Silver mines
- 3 Gold mines
- 4 Gemstone mines
- 5 Diamond mines
- 6 Shipbuilding monopoly
- 7 Merchant guild charter
- 8 Salt caverns
- 9 Crystal caves
- 10 Dragon hoard
- 11 Dwarven forge
- 12 Elven grove harvests
- 13 Arcane relics
- 14 Sea raider plunder
- 15 Sacred temple tithes
- 16 Farming
- 17 Fishing
- 18 Trade caravan routes
- 19 War spoils
- 20 Royal land grant

D20 GOAL

- 1 Reclaim lost lands
- 2 Restore honor
- 3 Secure royal favor
- 4 Expand influence
- 5 Marry into higher house
- 6 Eliminate rival house
- 7 Dominate regional politics
- 8 Accumulate forbidden magic
- 9 Awaken ancestral power
- 10 Break ancient curse
- 11 Secure bloodline purity
- 12 Gain seat on council
- 13 Ascend to royal status
- 14 Secure eternal succession
- 15 End ancient blood feud
- 16 Find new source of income
- 17 Find and kill all traitors
- 18 Enslave all commoners
- 19 Build underground kingdom
- 20 Ascend as immortal rulers

H. STREET NAMES

It's hard to navigate a busy town weren't it for those handy street names. These are often named after certain events, public figures or just what kind of commerce you find in the area. Make sure to name some streets after things you've already established in with the previous tables. Maybe a street will be named after the player characters later in the campaign?

D4+D12	1	2	3	4
1	Main	1 Victory	1 Layman's	1 Flogger's
2	King's	2 Lament	2 Eagle's	2 Hangman's
3	Queen's	3 Dagger	3 Gilded	3 Jester
4	Shepherd's	4 Bard's	4 Lookout	4 Thistle
5	Merchant	5 Neckbreaker	5 Whiteknuckle	5 Harmony
6	Market	6 Pickpocket	6 Great	6 Guard's
7	Theatre	7 Clover	7 Royal	7 Mead's
8	Deadbeat	8 Henchman's	8 Servant	8 Heckler's
9	Knight's	9 Soggy	9 Dreary	9 Sinner's
10	Dock	10 Stallion	10 River	10 Pennant
11	Temple	11 Wolfsbane	11 Bridge	11 Whisper
12	Liar's	12 Unlucky	12 Fortune	12 Swine

D12 SUFFIX

1	Road	4	Walk	7	Corner	10	Run
2	Way	5	Row	8	Avenue	11	Lane
3	Alley	6	Gate	9	Place	12	Court



2. INNS & TAVERNS

The inn is as old a fantasy staple as the genre itself. It is where adventurers rest their weary feet, trade stories, hear rumors, and spend their hard-earned coin on food, drink, and revelry. For the GM, however, inns can become repetitive over the course of a long campaign. Too often they blur together into a series of nearly identical common rooms and barkeeps. This chapter aims to help you make each inn memorable.

LOOK AND FEEL

It's easy to default to that inn from *"those movies about a magic ring"*. For many players, that's exactly what they expect the first time they step into a tavern in a fantasy roleplaying game. But recreating the same scene over and over can quickly lose its charm.

Fortunately, it doesn't take much to make an inn stand out. A handful of distinctive details can instantly transport the players somewhere new. Perhaps the floors are polished marble instead of rough timber. Perhaps the innkeeper is an automaton built by a long-dead wizard. Maybe the common room is carved into a giant tree, or lit entirely by bioluminescent fungi. Small touches often leave the strongest impressions.

WHO RUNS IT?

The innkeeper, their staff, and even the regular patrons can become valuable recurring NPCs throughout a campaign. The tables in this chapter provide tables to help bring them to life and make them easier for players to remember.

RUMORS

A few mugs of ale have a way of loosening tongues. Inns are natural gathering places for gossip and half-truths, making them an ideal source of adventure hooks. The rumor tables in this chapter generate ideas for you to build into full-fledged adventures.

A. ESTABLISHMENT NAME

To entice customers to sample your wares, you need a catchy name for your establishment. Roll on the tables below to generate names for cozy inns, shady taverns or even sleazy brothels. If you want a typical British naming-convention just roll twice on the noun tables (i.e. Crow & Shield, Coin & Flagon).

D20 ADJECTIVE	D20 NOUN 1	D20 NOUN 2
1 Wounded	1 Pig	1 Coin
2 Happy	2 Boar	2 Crown
3 Angry	3 Sailor	3 Scepter
4 Drunken	4 Pony	4 King
5 Flustered	5 Stag	5 Queen
6 Golden	6 Hound	6 Prince
7 Sparkling	7 Wolf	7 Anchor
8 Laughing	8 Raven	8 Oak
9 Sleeping	9 Lion	9 Rose
10 Roaring	10 Dragon	10 Oyster
11 Crooked	11 Serpent	11 Harp
12 Wandering	12 Fox	12 Shield
13 Burning	13 Ram	13 Tankard
14 Prancing	14 Bull	14 Goblet
15 Royal	15 Falcon	15 Flagon
16 Fallen	16 Goat	16 Knight
17 Shining	17 Badger	17 Barrel
18 Fleeing	18 Crow	18 Hearth
19 Sneaking	19 Bear	19 Lance
20 Boisterous	20 Mare	20 Quill

B. ESTABLISHMENT STYLE

Now that you have the name, you'll want your inn or tavern to have a distinct style, both inside and out. Roll on the tables below to generate ideas for what the establishment looks like and what makes it memorable.

D10 EXTERIOR STYLE

- 1 Timber-framed
- 2 Low stone structure
- 3 Tall, town house-building
- 4 Thatched-roof
- 5 Weather-worn wood building
- 6 Fortified, bunker-like
- 7 Boldly painted façade
- 8 Ivy-covered stone building
- 9 Masonry atop ancient ruin
- 10 Ramshackle structure

D10 INTERIOR STYLE

- 1 Low ceiling and cramped
- 2 Wide, open common room
- 3 Dark and smoke-filled
- 4 Bright, airy, many windows
- 5 Lavish and richly furnished
- 6 Sparse and utilitarian
- 7 Warm and hearth-centered
- 8 Maze-like with many rooms
- 9 Loud and chaotic
- 10 Quiet and intimate

D10 EXTERIOR DETAILS

- 1 Hanging creaking sign
- 2 Flower boxes by windows
- 3 Barred windows or shutters
- 4 Lanterns illuminate the front
- 5 Multiple smoking chimneys
- 6 Banners draped from balconies
- 7 Animal head above doorway
- 8 Iron-bound double doors
- 9 Fenced, muddy yard
- 10 Troublemakers at the door

D10 INTERIOR DETAILS

- 1 A hearth dominating one wall
- 2 Animal heads mounted on walls
- 3 Velvet curtains separating alcoves
- 4 Sawdust scattered across the floor
- 5 A polished bar worn smooth by time
- 6 Lanterns hanging from heavy chains
- 7 Stage for musicians or performers
- 8 A shrine tucked in a corner
- 9 Trapdoor leading to a cellar
- 10 Chandelier made from antlers

C. PROPRIETOR

The proprietor of the establishment must have the business acumen and charisma to keep it running. Here are some tables to help you generate the owner of your inn or tavern.

D20 VISAGE

- 1 A waxed curled mustache
- 2 Long braided hair
- 3 A patch over one eye
- 4 Burn scars
- 5 Rings on every finger
- 6 Wine stain on shirt cuff
- 7 A heavy velvet coat
- 8 Gold teeth, one missing
- 9 A colorful silk headscarf
- 10 Caterpillar-like unibrow
- 11 Repurposed military uniform
- 12 Ink-stained fingers
- 13 A broad leather apron
- 14 Seafarer's tattoos
- 15 A polished wooden peg leg
- 16 Keys in a chain at the belt
- 17 A crooked nose
- 18 Fine lace gloves
- 19 A wide, welcoming grin
- 20 Always a bit tipsy

D20 Demeanor

- 1 Warm and motherly/fatherly
- 2 Gruff but fair
- 3 Loud and boisterous
- 4 Quiet and observant
- 5 Slick and charming
- 6 Suspicious of strangers
- 7 Flirtatious and playful
- 8 Coldly professional
- 9 Overly polite and formal
- 10 Jaded and world-weary
- 11 Nervous and high-strung
- 12 Greedy but pragmatic
- 13 Proud and territorial
- 14 Secretive and calculating
- 15 Jovial and quick to laugh
- 16 Stern and disciplinarian
- 17 Hospitable to a fault
- 18 Bitter and sarcastic
- 19 Dramatic and theatrical
- 20 Calm and unflappable

D6 SHADY SIDE-HUSTLE

- | | |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1 Fencing stolen property | 4 Watering down expensive alcohol |
| 2 Underground gambling ring | 5 Skimming coin from guild revenues |
| 3 Hiding fugitives for a fee | 6 Running a killer-for-hire service |

D. HIRED HELP

In very small establishments, the owner might handle all the work, but that is rarely sustainable. Hired help is almost always necessary. Sometimes the staff are family members, or people working to repay a large debt.

D20 WHO

- 1 A few close family members
- 2 The owner's spouse
- 3 Some village youths
- 4 Retired soldier
- 5 Traveler working for a meal
- 6 Debtor working off a loan
- 7 A pair of former adventurers
- 8 A runaway noble
- 9 A settled down former sailor
- 10 A mournful widow
- 11 A gambler repaying debt
- 12 Dwarves with attitude
- 13 A few tranquil elves
- 14 A bunch of cheerful halflings
- 15 A band of loud gnomes
- 16 A disgraced town guard
- 17 A failed, tone-deaf bard
- 18 A tall and strong half-orc
- 19 A pair of faulty automatons
- 20 A talking and walking bear

D20 SERVICE

- 1 Moves incredibly fast
- 2 Painfully slow
- 3 Friendly and welcoming
- 4 Rude but efficient
- 5 Writes everything down
- 6 Talks too much
- 7 Eager for gossip
- 8 Seems half asleep
- 9 Always humming a tune
- 10 Drops things often
- 11 Acts like a drill sergeant
- 12 Complains about the owner
- 13 Praises the establishment
- 14 Refuses to write anything down
- 15 Easily distracted
- 16 Constantly wiping tables
- 17 Mixes up tables
- 18 Pushes the most expensive meal
- 19 Clearly hates the job
- 20 Laughs at every joke

D6 WHAT TROUBLES THEM

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1 The meager pay, no tips | 4 The anger of the proprietor |
| 2 Rowdy customers rioting | 5 The quality of food and drink |
| 3 Bad reviews | 6 The past coming to haunt them |

E. PATRONS

The inn is a great place to introduce colorful NPCs for the player characters to interact with. You can, of course, stat them out using your favorite game system, but in most cases, only NPCs who come into conflict with the PCs or join them on adventures need more than a few details.

D20 WHO

- 1 An oldtimer with old stories
- 2 An energetic youngster
- 3 An award winning poet
- 4 A retired mercenary
- 5 A nervous merchant
- 6 A traveling musician
- 7 A failed inventor
- 8 A boastful hunter
- 9 A mysterious pilgrim
- 10 A disgraced noble
- 11 A fortune teller
- 12 A homesick sailor
- 13 A cheerful gambler
- 14 A wounded veteran
- 15 A wandering scholar
- 16 A loud fisherman
- 17 A debt-ridden farmer
- 18 A suspicious stranger
- 19 A runaway apprentice
- 20 A local troublemaker

D20 WHAT THEY WANT

- 1 Find love
- 2 Get back at those who wronged them
- 3 Drink away the bad memories
- 4 Gather secrets and lore
- 5 Have a great time
- 6 Make friends
- 7 Someone to pay for their drinks
- 8 Find a lover for tonight
- 9 Hide from the authorities
- 10 Confess to someone
- 11 Find work
- 12 Blend in with normal people
- 13 Fight someone
- 14 The key to the wine cellar
- 15 Somewhere to sleep for tonight
- 16 Someone to believe in them
- 17 Someone to rob in the back alley
- 18 Confess their love to another NPC
- 19 Gain respect
- 20 Help with a problem

F. MENU

Adventurers coming back from a long and arduous trek are bound to be hungry and thirsty. Thankfully, there's plenty to choose from at the local inn or tavern. Roll on the tables for staples on the menu, or maybe the chef has cooked up a special just for today.

D20 FOOD

- | | |
|----|------------------------------|
| 1 | Gruel |
| 2 | Fish soup |
| 3 | Cheese platter |
| 4 | Rabbit pie |
| 5 | Baked eel |
| 6 | Chicken and leek pie |
| 7 | Roast venison |
| 8 | Cabbage and bacon stew |
| 9 | Apple and onion tart |
| 10 | Salt mutton with cabbage |
| 11 | Pottage |
| 12 | Wild boar surprise |
| 13 | Honey-glazed ham |
| 14 | Sausage in beans |
| 15 | Lapskaus (northern delicacy) |
| 16 | Slow-cooked sheep's head |
| 17 | Bone-marrow and herbs |
| 18 | All-you-can-eat buffet |
| 19 | Slop (stewed leftovers) |
| 20 | Roasted duck |

D20 DRINK

- | | |
|----|-------------------------------------|
| 1 | Dwarven ale |
| 2 | Apple cider |
| 3 | Honeyed milk |
| 4 | Halfling whisky |
| 5 | Elven mint tea |
| 6 | Castle-smasher (48% hard liquor) |
| 7 | Elven mead |
| 8 | Headbuster (98% hard liquor) |
| 9 | Witches' brew (not really) |
| 10 | Gnome wine |
| 11 | Adventurer's Best Friend (cocktail) |
| 12 | The Cleanser (tasty, but laxative) |
| 13 | Old King's Reserve (wine) |
| 14 | Deepdelver stout |
| 15 | Goblin rotgut |
| 16 | Pixie nectar (controversial) |
| 17 | Blackroot bitters |
| 18 | Sea foam (whisky sour) |
| 19 | Beer (watered down) |
| 20 | Fruit cordial |

G. ENTERTAINMENT

In larger cities, competition between inns can get quite fierce, so various forms of entertainment are provided to draw crowds to their establishments. Roll to see what entertainment the inn offers on any given night.

D20 ENTERTAINMENT

- 1 Pie eating contest. Winner drinks for free for one month
- 2 Dancing troupe with funny hats and jolly songs
- 3 Poetry night for beginners. Usually dreadful
- 4 Knife throwing contest. Owner takes no responsibility for accidents
- 5 Popular performing bard sings drinking songs
- 6 Meditative music performed by exotic band
- 7 Masked dancer performing mysterious and hypnotic number
- 8 Open stage for speeches and tall tales
- 9 Tournament in a complex dice or card game
- 10 Pipe smoking contest making visibility poor and breathing hard
- 11 Amateur singing contest. Earplugs can be bought expensively
- 12 Fortune wheel gambling night. Rumored to be rigged
- 13 Traveling illusionist magic show
- 14 A puppet show with grotesque special effects
- 15 Competitive drinking endurance trial
- 16 Trained bear performs tricks for coins. Trainer seems nervous
- 17 Rat racing tournament. Betting strongly encouraged
- 18 Cook-off using only rare and questionable ingredients
- 19 Beard judging competition with heated arguments
- 20 Taxidermied animal beauty pageant. Surprisingly popular

H. RUMORS

The proprietor and guests hear many rumors, and sometimes there is truth in the drunken talk shared over food and drink. Use these rumors together with your world map. Roll to determine the direction from which the rumor originates.

D20 RUMORS

- 1 A hunter never returned from the woods. His dog came back alone
- 2 A hidden cave behind a waterfall. Locals swear it wasn't there before
- 3 A trapper's camp lies ruined. No sign of the trappers
- 4 Hypnotic chanting heard in the marsh
- 5 An old barrow lies open. The stone lid has been pushed aside
- 6 Black bone arrows of unknown origin were found stuck in a tree
- 7 Ravens circle the same hill every day
- 8 A wagon burned by the road. The cargo and driver are gone
- 9 A bell rings in the fog. There is no chapel nearby
- 10 A giant footprint was found by the stream. Too large for any man
- 11 The old rope bridge collapsed overnight, seemingly sabotaged
- 12 War-drums can be heard coming from deep in the forest
- 13 A dark and imposing tower only shows at night
- 14 An old and toothless hermit talks of a doomsday prophecy
- 15 An unidentified beast crossed the fields recently
- 16 Black ships seen at sea
- 17 Something lurks beneath the dark waters, calling its young
- 18 In an abandoned battlefield, the dead don't stay dead
- 19 A peculiar stone formation glows faintly in the night
- 20 A dark cave that emanates an evil wind

D8 SOURCE OF RUMOR

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| 1 North | 5 South |
| 2 North-east | 6 South-west |
| 3 East | 7 West |
| 4 South-east | 8 North-west |



3. THE ADVENTURERS' GUILD

Many adventurers are free agents, independent to a fault, and many meet their doom while searching for lost treasures in dark mazes. As members of an adventurers' guild, they would have access to better maps, better weapons and armor, and even retainers to improve their chances in the dark places of the world.

THERE'S NO SUCH THING AS A FREE LUNCH

There is usually no upfront cost to join an adventurers' guild, but a portion of the treasure members recover from quests is owed to the guild. These funds are used to maintain the headquarters, pay administrative staff, and acquire shared resources such as weapons, armor, tools, and even spells. The larger the guild's share, the more powerful and prestigious it tends to be.

CODE OF CONDUCT

Different adventurers' guilds have their own rules and quirks, usually shaped by the founders' ideals of what an adventurer should be. Some guilds follow the dogma of a god or a particular alignment. If the rules are broken in the wilderness, few will ever know, but in towns rumors spread fast. Breaking the guild's code can lead to expulsion, or worse.

THIEVES' GUILD VS. ADVENTURERS' GUILD

In practice, there is often little to distinguish a thieves' guild from an adventurers' guild, and some chaotic-aligned guilds are virtually indistinguishable from outright thieves' guilds. The main difference is composition: a thieves' guild is primarily made up of thieves, while an adventurers' guild draws from all manner of classes. For that reason, it is important for an adventurers' guild to maintain a broad and balanced membership, and never allow an overrepresentation of thieves.

A. GUILD NAME

A lot rides on a guild's name. To inspire membership, secure contracts, and deter rival guilds, naming is not to be taken lightly. It is uncommon for a guild to change its name once established, which means the origins of some guilds' names become obscure over time. Use this table to generate the name of an adventurers' guild. Roll once on each column and combine the results to create a memorable guild name for your campaign world.

D20 FIRST

1 The Golden

2 The Silver

3 The Iron

4 The Crimson

5 The Black

6 The White

7 The Emerald

8 The Azure

9 The Scarlet

10 The Storm

11 The Shadow

12 The Radiant

13 The Ancient

14 The Wandering

15 The Free

16 The Stalwart

17 The Valiant

18 The Hidden

19 The Last

20 The Secret

D20 SECOND

1 Company

2 Brotherhood

3 Sisterhood

4 Order

5 League

6 Guild

7 Band

8 Circle

9 Fellowship

10 Watch

11 Guard

12 Blades

13 Seekers

14 Wardens

15 Pathfinders

16 Delvers

17 Hunters

18 Freeblades

19 Cloaks

20 Adventurers

B. GUILD CODE

Every adventurers' guild has its own history and trajectory, shaped by triumphs and failures, which has made it necessary to establish written rules to keep the guild in order. The code can often be traced back to the guild's founding, reflecting the founder's personal beliefs. Below is a table you can use to generate a few articles for the guild code.

D20 GUILD CODE ARTICLE

- 1 Thou shalt not draw steel within the guildhall
- 2 Thou shalt render aid unto a fellow guild member in peril
- 3 Thou shalt pay thy dues before the turning of the moon
- 4 Thou shalt not steal from guild, companion, nor client
- 5 Thou shalt keep secret the affairs of the guild
- 6 Thou shalt honor all lawful contracts once sworn
- 7 Thou shalt not abandon thy company in battle
- 8 Thou shalt return all borrowed gear in good condition
- 9 Thou shalt not claim another's deed as thine own
- 10 Thou shalt show courtesy unto guild officers
- 11 Thou shalt not bring outsiders within the guild gates
- 12 Thou shalt give fair warning of known dangers
- 13 Thou shalt not disturb the honored dead
- 14 Thou shalt keep thy weapons sharp and thy wits sharper
- 15 Thou shalt answer the guild's summons when able
- 16 Thou shalt not employ sorcery against a guild member
- 17 Thou wilt leave no companion's body for scavengers
- 18 Thou wilt share maps and discoveries with the guild
- 19 Thou wilt surrender one tenth of thy reward unto the guild
- 20 Thou wilt uphold the guild's honor in all lands

C. GUILD LEADER

The leaders of adventurers' guilds are often retired adventurers or individuals with a military background. Sometimes, they are simply wealthy patrons who prefer to let others undertake the dangerous work. Use the tables below to generate the leader of the local adventurers' guild. Roll for their appearance, personality, and a hidden detail, if you're so inclined.

D20 VISAGE

- 1 Battle-scarred face
- 2 Typical noble appearance
- 3 Flamboyant and dashing
- 4 Weather-beaten veteran
- 5 Long-braided beard
- 6 Missing an eye (patched?)
- 7 Tattooed face or neck
- 8 Youthful
- 9 Broad-shouldered
- 10 Lean and foxlike
- 11 Old but sharp-eyed
- 12 Burn scars
- 13 Dressed in fine clothing
- 14 Wild unkempt hair
- 15 Groomed and tidy
- 16 Numerous rings and jewelry
- 17 Dark hood hiding face
- 18 Permanent smirk
- 19 Deep-set tired eyes
- 20 Short but stocky built

D20 DEMEANOR

- 1 Always testing people
- 2 Constantly joking
- 3 Charismatic speaker
- 4 World-weary and cynical
- 5 Strict and disciplined
- 6 Patient and thoughtful
- 7 Flirtatious and playful
- 8 Hot-tempered
- 9 Quiet observer
- 10 Enigmatic and mysterious
- 11 Secretive and guarded
- 12 Proud and boastful
- 13 Distrustful and territorial
- 14 Encouraging and supportive
- 15 Dismissive of incompetence
- 16 Overly cautious
- 17 Morally rigid
- 18 Pragmatic and practical
- 19 Friendly and welcoming
- 20 Gruff but fair

D4 BUT DID YOU KNOW...

- 1 ...they possess a powerful magical item they keep hidden
- 2 ...they were once a famous adventurer whose deeds are still sung about
- 3 ...they once betrayed a former adventuring party
- 4 ...they are not the real leader but a stand-in for someone else

D. HEADQUARTER SITE

Depending on the guild's cash flow, its headquarters may be sparse, utilitarian, or resemble a military outpost. Use this table to determine where the local adventurers' guild is based. While grand guild halls exist in great cities, most guilds operate from whatever buildings they can afford or acquire.

D20 SITE

- 1 Guild Hall
- 2 Fortified keep
- 3 Converted tavern
- 4 Old watchtower
- 5 Abandoned temple
- 6 Merchant manor
- 7 City barracks
- 8 Dockside warehouse
- 9 Ancient ruin
- 10 Former noble estate
- 11 Town hall annex
- 12 Underground hall
- 13 Old mill
- 14 Market square office
- 15 City gatehouse
- 16 Caravan yard
- 17 Back rooms of a shop
- 18 Stable loft
- 19 Fishermen's hall
- 20 Bell tower

D20 IT HAS A SECRET

- 1 Hidden tunnel beneath the guild
- 2 Ghost of a fallen adventurer
- 3 Secret vaults in the walls
- 4 Monster kept in the cellar
- 5 Cursed item locked away
- 6 Hidden shrine underground
- 7 Secret meeting chamber
- 8 Old smuggling passage
- 9 Rival spies inside the guild
- 10 Sealed door no one opens
- 11 Forgotten map hidden somewhere
- 12 Haunted trophy on the wall
- 13 Secret escape route
- 14 Ancient ruin below the building
- 15 Magical warded chamber
- 16 Disguised creature visiting often
- 17 Buried treasure under the floor
- 18 Hidden trapdoor
- 19 Old bloodstain that returns
- 20 Secret room behind a bookshelf

E. HEADQUARTER ROOMS

Use these tables to determine what rooms exist in the adventurers' guild headquarters. The common rooms represent the practical spaces most guilds start with, while the uncommon rooms reflect greater wealth or prestige. They can also serve as inspiration for rooms the guild may build later.

D20 COMMON

- 1 Common room
- 2 Meeting hall
- 3 Sleeping quarters
- 4 Kitchen
- 5 Pantry
- 6 Armory
- 7 Storage room
- 8 Map room
- 9 Stable
- 10 Training yard
- 11 Office
- 12 Guest room
- 13 Workshop
- 14 Library
- 15 Cellar
- 16 Mess hall
- 17 Reception hall
- 18 Equipment room
- 19 Notice board room
- 20 Courtyard

D20 UNCOMMON

- 1 Trophy hall
- 2 Monster menagerie
- 3 Secret vault
- 4 Arcane laboratory
- 5 Hidden escape tunnel
- 6 Interrogation chamber
- 7 Shrine
- 8 Alchemy lab
- 9 War room
- 10 Magical portal chamber
- 11 Private dueling room
- 12 Prison cells
- 13 Underground fighting pit
- 14 Occult library
- 15 Strategy chamber
- 16 Srying chamber
- 17 Secret council room
- 18 Artifact vault
- 19 Wizard's study
- 20 Secret passage network

F. THE GUILD'S WOES

Use these tables to determine the current concerns of the adventurers' guild. Immediate worries require swift action and may lead directly to new quests, while long-term worries hint at larger problems slowly developing. The next table lists more concrete missions to use right away.

D20 IMMEDIATE

- 1 Missing members on mission
- 2 Dangerous monster near town
- 3 Guild coffers running low
- 4 Rival guild stealing contracts
- 5 Noble demanding favors
- 6 Bandits targeting members
- 7 Supplies running out
- 8 Important client waiting
- 9 Monster escaping its cell
- 10 Spy amongst the members
- 11 Member causing trouble
- 12 Map to a dungeon stolen
- 13 Town guard suspicious
- 14 Contract gone wrong
- 15 Caravan needing escort
- 16 Wounded party returning
- 17 Dangerous artifact located
- 18 Fight breaking out in the guild
- 19 Client refusing to pay
- 20 Thief stealing equipment

D20 LONG-TERM

- 1 Rival guild growing stronger
- 2 Looming war in the region
- 3 Monsters increasing in number
- 4 Dangerous dungeon left unexplored
- 5 Corrupt noble gaining influence
- 6 Guild falling into debt
- 7 Town slowly declining
- 8 Ancient evil stirring nearby
- 9 Competition from independents
- 10 Guild reputation worsening
- 11 Strange fungi spreading, rotting trees
- 12 Members leaving for rival guild
- 13 Prophecy concerning the guild
- 14 Lost artifact yet to be found
- 15 Rival faction infiltrating the guild
- 16 Growing criminal syndicate
- 17 A plague spreading from town to town
- 18 Powerful monster in the wilderness
- 19 Old enemies returning
- 20 A mysterious cult spreading

G. GUILD QUESTS

The primary purpose of an adventurers' guild is to provide work for its members. In exchange for assigning contracts, the guild typically takes a percentage of the reward earned from completed missions (1/10 is normal). These contracts are called quests, but more often than not the guild has its own motives, and the quests tend to serve its ambitions.

D20 CITY QUESTS

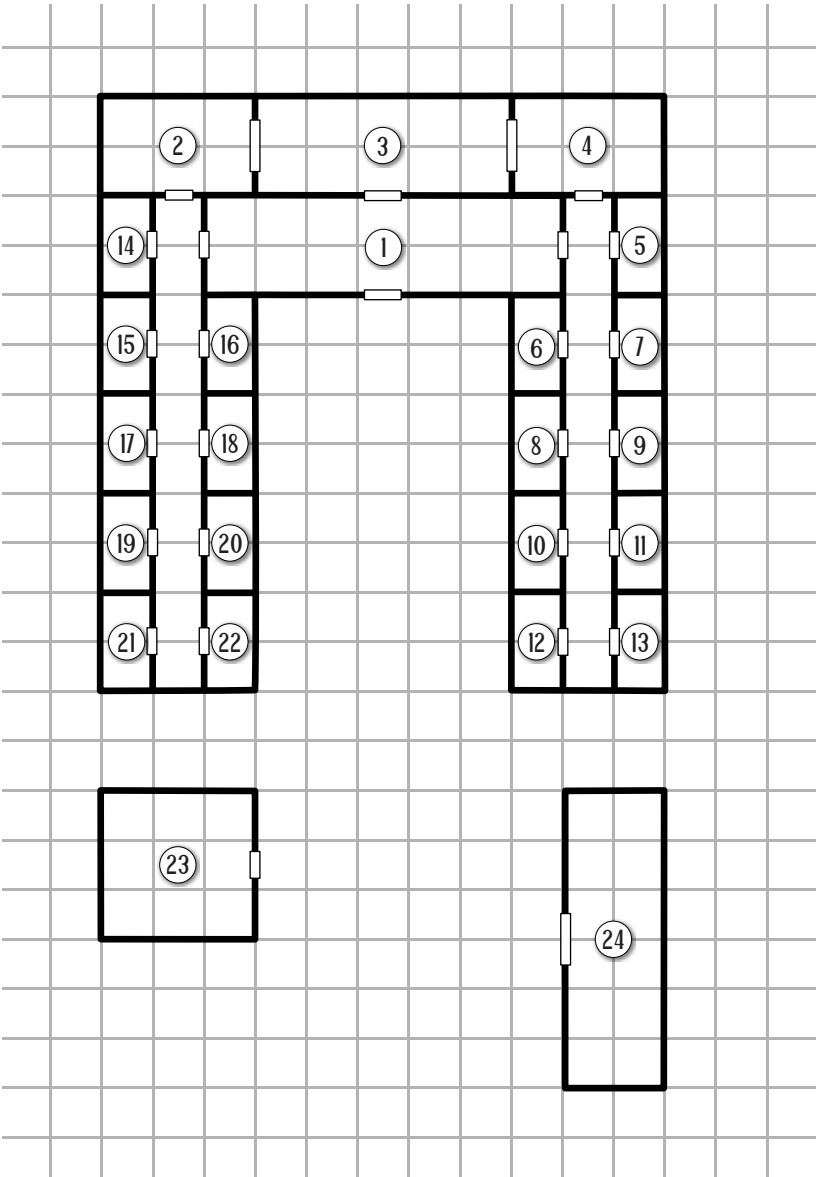
- 1 Rescue noble's kidnapped child
- 2 Deliver sealed letter tonight
- 3 Look into tainted wine shipment
- 4 Escort witness through city
- 5 Protect tavern from arsonists
- 6 Investigate haunted noble estate
- 7 Expose corrupt city guard
- 8 Find blackmailing informant
- 9 Destroy underground fight ring
- 10 Retrieve arcane smuggled cargo
- 11 Sabotage rival adventurer's guild
- 12 Intercept ransom exchange
- 13 Steal map from archives
- 14 Stop ritual at midnight
- 15 Capture fleeing informant alive
- 16 Guard shipment of gold
- 17 Recover stolen sacred relic
- 18 Uncover traitor within guild
- 19 Protect caravan within walls
- 20 Destroy illegal potion lab

D20 WILDERNESS QUESTS

- 1 Retrieve relic from ruins
- 2 Destroy enemy war camp
- 3 Locate lost expedition party
- 4 Guard important outpost
- 5 Track escaped murderer
- 6 Deliver cure across wilderness
- 7 Clear beast's lair
- 8 Seal portal in ruins
- 9 Map unexplored region
- 10 Rescue trapped cave miners
- 11 Deliver mail to distant town
- 12 Recruit new members
- 13 Find source of undead scourge
- 14 Protect caravan on journey
- 15 Explore ruins, retrieve gold
- 16 Help village in peril
- 17 Continue exploring dungeon
- 18 Stop source of corruption
- 19 Negotiate peace with two sides
- 20 Follow a treasure map

H. EXAMPLE HQ MAP

In a West Marches campaign centered around an adventurers' guild, you might need a map of the headquarters. Here is an example map with 24 rooms for you to fill using rooms from Table E. It could be a noble mansion, an old townhouse, or something similar. Rooms 23 and 24 are separate buildings not connected to the main structure, such as a barn and a warehouse.





4. VENDORS & MERCHANTS

A busy city is rife with entrepreneurs and opportunists, as well as people simply trying to make ends meet. Traveling merchants undertake dangerous journeys to sell their wares to wealthy adventurers in need of specialized gear. Occasionally, a truly rare artifact can be found in an obscure shop or market stall.

SHOPS LARGE AND SMALL

Populate your city with bazaar stalls, cramped shops, or even spacious, luxurious emporiums. We help you determine what kind of store it is, how it looks, and what the vendor or merchant is selling.

WE SPENT HOURS AT THE WEAPON SMITH

It's become a common trope, especially in the last decade, for players to spend hours in weapon shops and other stores during roleplaying sessions. We don't want to encourage that, since the real adventure lies elsewhere, but a world does feel more alive when the people trying to sell you things have personalities. In this short chapter, you'll find tools to help you give shopkeepers more character in your fantasy roleplaying game.

I GOT THE GOOD STUFF UNDER THE COUNTER

A merchant may present themselves as one thing, but often has something else hidden away, if you know what to ask, or have the right password. You can find out what the trader keeps under the counter for special or wealthy customers.

Λ. SHOP APPEARANCE

Shops come in many forms, so first roll on the table to determine the type of shop. In the second column, roll once or more if the shop type suggests multiple vendors selling their wares in the same place. The final column lists shop quirks. Some may not fit your result, so reroll until you find one that suits the shop and helps personalize it.

D20 TYPE	D20 TRADE	D20 SHOP QUIRK
1 Market stall	1 Weaponsmith	1 Cramped and cluttered
2 Merchant stand	2 Armorer	2 Immaculately organized
3 Bazaar booth	3 Bowyer	3 Dimly lit
4 Traveling cart	4 Fletcher	4 Smells strongly of herbs
5 Roadside stall	5 Alchemist	5 Filled with hanging tools
6 Village shop	6 Herbalist	6 Decorated with charms and runes
7 General store	7 Jeweler	7 Covered in faded banners
8 Trading post	8 Cartwright	8 Packed with customers
9 City emporium	9 Book seller	9 Dusty and neglected
10 Backroom dealer	10 Map maker	10 Recently renovated
11 Guild trade house	11 Fortune teller	11 Heavy wooden counters
12 Merchant house	12 Trinket dealer	12 Shelves reaching the ceiling
13 Peddler's cart	13 Pawn broker	13 Bare and functional
14 Alleyway kiosk	14 Tailor	14 Richly decorated
15 Caravan wagon	15 Tanner	15 Everything behind locked glass
16 Pavilion-tent	16 General Goods	16 Bright and colorful
17 Rug-stall	17 Baker	17 Covered in soot
18 Sack with wares	18 Butcher	18 Warm and welcoming
19 Riverboat	19 Brewer	19 Cold and sterile
20 Cellar shop	20 Exotic trader	20 Filled with strange curiosities

B. SHOPKEEPER

The shopkeeper's personality can determine whether haggling is possible, or if they take offense at the attempt. A thief in the party may also try to steal goods undetected, where personality can play a key role. Finally, some wares are only sold to select customers. Roll and find out what they are.

D20 PERSONALITY

- 1 Animated and talkative
- 2 Gruff and foul-mouthed
- 3 Depressed and desperate
- 4 Silver-tongued and flirty
- 5 Stressed and inattentive
- 6 Just keeps on talking
- 7 Suspicious to newcomers
- 8 Always tired or half-asleep
- 9 Quiet, just points at wares
- 10 Shy with head in clouds
- 11 Proud of family tradition
- 12 Part-time adventurer
- 13 Aggressive to browsers
- 14 Drunk and unruly
- 15 Loves gossip and slander
- 16 Narcissistic know-it-all
- 17 Easily charmed by coin
- 18 All anecdotes and tall tales
- 19 Only respects barterers
- 20 Tries to get rid of all, fast

D20 BEHIND THE COUNTER

- 1 Rare herbs
- 2 Antique weapons
- 3 Monster parts
- 4 Illegal potions
- 5 Exotic spices
- 6 Strange maps
- 7 Ancient coins
- 8 Foreign tools
- 9 Rare fabrics
- 10 Fine wines
- 11 Monster trophies
- 12 Unusual books
- 13 Lucky charms
- 14 Rare metals
- 15 Exotic wood
- 16 Ancient relic fragments
- 17 Strange mechanical devices
- 18 Odd musical instruments
- 19 Decorative statues
- 20 Travel gear



5. TEMPLES & SHRINES

In a typical old school campaign temples are frequent destinations where adventurers recover health. In more modern campaigns, they are often sought out for the resurrection of fallen companions. Because of this, temples present excellent opportunities for worldbuilding, role-playing, and even political intrigue.

WHERE ARE THE GODS?

We have not provided specific deities here, as those are usually supplied by the game system you are using. Instead, we have included a domain table that can help determine the nature of the deity worshipped at a given temple. Use it alongside your chosen system to match an existing religion or create an entirely new faith of your own.

HOUSE OF THE HOLY

The services temples provide are essential to adventurers. As a GM, make it clear that the characters are entering a sacred place. Reverence is expected, and those who fail to show proper respect may find themselves denied the temple's services.

SPIRITUAL PRACTICES

Fantasy religions can be strange, unsettling, and deeply rooted in the superstitions and customs of medieval and pagan societies. Their rituals may appear cruel to outsiders. This creates an interesting dilemma for players. When they desperately need healing or divine aid, they may have to confront the uncomfortable realities of the faith they depend upon. Watching, or even participating in, these rites can become memorable roleplaying moments in their own right.

Λ. CLERGY NAME

A fantasy world truly comes alive through its religions and sacred institutions. Temples, cults, and priesthoods can inspire awe, spark conflict, offer guidance, or become dangerous foes. The name of a religious order should evoke reverence or dread.

D20 ORGANIZATION	D20 DESCRIPTOR	D20 SYMBOL
1 Brotherhood of	1 The Holy	1 Flame
2 Sisterhood of	2 The Sacred	2 Crown
3 Order of	3 The Radiant	3 Star
4 Temple of	4 The Burning	4 Dawn
5 Cult of	5 The Silent	5 All-seeing eye
6 Church of	6 The Eternal	6 Hand
7 Keepers of	7 The Veiled	7 Chalice
8 Guardians of	8 The Crimson	8 Key
9 Servants of	9 The Golden	9 Shield
10 Disciples of	10 The Iron	10 Lantern
11 Children of	11 The Fallen	11 Rose
12 Knights of	12 The Hidden	12 Scroll
13 Pilgrims of	13 The Shining	13 Bell
14 Followers of	14 The Mystic	14 Pillar
15 Priests of	15 The Blessed	15 Stone
16 Chosen of	16 The Esoteric	16 Path
17 Hands of	17 The Penitent	17 Throne
18 Voice of	18 The Black	18 Gate
19 Wardens of	19 The Silver	19 Light
20 Seekers of	20 The Forgotten	20 King

B. GENERAL FEATURES

The clergy's place of worship is often the part of a religious institution that adventurers interact with most frequently, whether they seek healing, blessings, guidance, or relief from curses. Roll for deity domain if you want inspiration for what kind of god they worship, or use it as this temple's particular interpretation of one of the gods in your campaign setting.

D12 DEITY DOMAIN

1	Sun
2	War
3	Storms
4	Death
5	Knowledge
6	Harvest
7	Justice
8	Sea
9	Travel
10	Trickery
11	Fire
12	Moon

D12 TEMPLE TYPE

1	Grand cathedral
2	Stone temple
3	Small shrine
4	Roadside chapel
5	Monastery
6	Sacred grove
7	Temple-fortress
8	Cliffside shrine
9	Underground temple
10	Pilgrim hospice
11	Ruined temple still in use
12	Hidden cult sanctuary

D6 SERVICES OFFERED

1	Healing / resurrection
2	Blessings / magical cures
3	Divinations / prophecies
4	Curses lifted / exorcism
5	Funerals / sacred rites
6	Holy quests / sacred relics

D6 OPENING HOURS

1	A few hours at dawn and dusk
2	From dawn until midday
3	During daylight hours only
4	At dawn, noon, and sunset
5	All day, but closes after evening prayers
6	Always open

C. TEMPLE DETAILS

Now we come to the details that make the temple truly memorable. Combined with the results you've already generated, these tables should give you a much clearer sense of how the religion operates and how its temple functions on a day-to-day basis. Feel free to roll on the following tables more than once if you want to add further depth, complexity, or unusual features to the temple.

D20 TEMPLE FEATURES

- 1 Eternal flame
- 2 Sacred pool
- 3 Huge statue
- 4 Ringing bells
- 5 Painted ceiling
- 6 Bones of saints
- 7 Whispering idols
- 8 Wall of prayers
- 9 Central holy tree
- 10 Glowing altar
- 11 Massive bronze doors
- 12 Carved pillars
- 13 Hanging braziers
- 14 Ancient murals
- 15 Sealed relic
- 16 Holy fountain
- 17 Stone sarcophagus
- 18 Hidden crypt
- 19 Sacred fire pit
- 20 Garden of herbs

D20 CLERGY FEATURES

- 1 Twirling ritual scars
- 2 Masked or veiled
- 3 Golden vestments
- 4 Blindfolded or blinded
- 5 Flagellant penance
- 6 Sacred tattoos
- 7 Only men/women
- 8 Heavy ceremonial robes
- 9 Painted holy symbol on faces
- 10 Vow of silence or cut tongues
- 11 Covered in ritual jewelry
- 12 Perpetually chanting
- 13 Sacred amputations
- 14 All men are castrated
- 15 Partially or wholly naked
- 16 Shaved heads, ash-covered skin
- 17 Marked with ritual brands
- 18 Always barefoot
- 19 Wearing heavy iron chains
- 20 Faces hidden behind painted masks

D8 TEMPLE RITUALS

- | | |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1 Sacrifice of animals | 5 Prayers or meditation |
| 2 Sacrifice of coin (melted) | 6 Sacrifice of limbs |
| 3 Sacrifice of people (willing) | 7 Trance-inducing dance |
| 4 Sacrificial scarring | 8 Reading holy texts aloud |

D. SPIRITUAL LEADER

We've placed the tables for the clergy's leadership at the end of this section because everything that comes before helps shape who that leader is. The temple's traditions, beliefs, and practices should all inform the person standing at its head. This figure might be the founder of the faith, the current high priest, or simply the spiritual leader of this particular temple.

D20 VISAGE

- 1 Old and decrepit
- 2 A child, wise beyond years
- 3 Mutated, warped, changed
- 4 A talking animal
- 5 Beautiful, statuesque
- 6 Taller than any man
- 7 Emanates radiant light
- 8 Shrouded in darkness
- 9 Walks on all fours
- 10 Perpetually in trance
- 11 Levitates or flying
- 12 Fused with throne
- 13 A third lidless eye on forehead
- 14 Changes appearance at will
- 15 Can't look directly at them
- 16 A sentient holy artifact
- 17 Crazed and dirty
- 18 Half human, half animal
- 19 A truly alien lifeform
- 20 A levitating orb of faith

D20 DEMEANOR

- 1 Calm and serene
- 2 Cold and distant
- 3 Warm and compassionate
- 4 Intensely focused
- 5 Gentle and nurturing
- 6 Unshakably optimistic
- 7 Overly forgiving, even of enemies
- 8 Speaks in layered metaphors
- 9 Unnaturally still when speaking
- 10 Suspicious of all outsiders
- 11 Overwhelmed by sadness
- 12 Always eating
- 13 Too friendly
- 14 In pain from disease
- 15 Longing for a lost love
- 16 Relies on servants for everything
- 17 Easily distracted
- 18 Always commenting on appearances
- 19 Eager to sell and/or buy things
- 20 Speaks as a direct link to their deity

D8 SPIRITUAL LEADER GOAL

- | | |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1 Destroy all other religions | 5 Be the world's dominant religion |
| 2 Take over power in town | 6 Destroy religion from inside |
| 3 Erect a cathedral | 7 Ready a successor to take over |
| 4 Sacrifice all to transcend | 8 Go on a pilgrimage |



6. CITY ENCOUNTERS

People flock to cities for countless reasons. The beggar dreams of a warm meal, the adventurer seeks work and fortune, the merchant hopes to turn a profit, and the noble schemes from behind palace walls. Whatever their station, everyone wants something. A city is full of opportunity, but traversing its streets can be a risk to both life and coin.

NIGHT AND DAY ENCOUNTERS

We have provided tables for both daytime and nighttime encounters, as trouble is far more likely to find those who wander the streets after dark. The tables are further divided into safe and unsafe areas. What constitutes a safe or unsafe area is up to you, but poorer neighborhoods are often the most perilous, as the city watch rarely concerns itself with what happens there. Temples, castles, noble estates, and their surrounding grounds are usually well guarded and can generally be considered safe.

OFF-SCREEN DEVELOPMENTS

The final two tables cover events that unfold while the characters are occupied elsewhere. A living city does not stand still simply because the players are not looking. Rivalries grow, fortunes rise and fall, crimes are committed, and strange happenings unfold.

These two tables are intended for use by the GM between sessions, once some time has passed in the campaign. The entries may not always fit perfectly with the specifics of your city, but they are broad and flexible enough to be adapted or reinterpreted to suit your setting. Choosing which table to use can be left to a die roll, or it can be guided by the events of recent sessions. The GM may decide whether the city is currently on an upward or downward trajectory based on player actions, shaping which developments are more likely to occur. Any of these developments can become adventures should the players choose to involve themselves in them.

A. DAY TIME (SAFE AREA)

Daytime encounters in a safe, well-populated city with an active city guard should rarely involve heavy combat. Use the entries as inspiration to improvise small side quests, or even longer storylines if the players become interested.

D20 SAFE AREA

- 1 An impoverished child wants to sell over-priced pine cone animals
- 2 A drunk woman with a pearl necklace raves on about the flawed government
- 3 The sun catches the reflection of something unusual on a rooftop nearby
- 4 A pack of dogs is chasing a young boy into a back alley
- 5 A seemingly naive young couple asks for directions, while picking pockets
- 6 About a dozen people are gathering in an alley to bet on a cock fight
- 7 An unusual looking cat starts following you
- 8 An old and deranged woman points out one of you and utters: «death!»
- 9 Three aggressive bulls are thundering down the street towards you
- 10 A nobleman in a carriage throws some coins to you, asking for directions
- 11 A scruffy looking man is selling smut novels, all featuring werewolves
- 12 Representatives from a new religion wants you to join their faith
- 13 A flamboyant old lady is selling exotic birds and small animals
- 14 A town crier proclaims «fight in the arena, win amazing prizes!»
- 15 Smoke is billowing from the nearest bakery, there could be a fire
- 16 Harlots make fun of you from a balcony nearby
- 17 A fortune-teller in an open cart offers to tell you your fortunes
- 18 An elderly man offers to buy one of your weapons for «personal reasons»
- 19 A local mobster wants you to transport his cart to the other side of town
- 20 A dangerous beast has escaped the traveling circus and has you cornered

B. DAY TIME (UNSAFE AREA)

There are some areas where the city guard does not care much, and crime runs rampant. Even during the day, the player characters run the risk of confrontation, pickpocketing, and charlatans looking for easy targets.

D20 UNSAFE AREA

- 1 Animated vines pull you into a mischievous wizard's dwelling
- 2 A shady character tries to sell illegal drugs
- 3 Members of a local gang claims you are «stepping on their turf»
- 4 A woman is stuck between two crates in a back alley, seems suspicious
- 5 Ruffians approach you with the intent to beat you up and mug you
- 6 Crooked city guards shake you down for «street tax»
- 7 A muffled scream can be heard from a cellar nearby
- 8 A dozen children surrounds you with clubs and knives, demanding coin
- 9 Someone is following you, just out of sight
- 10 An arts-dealer needs protection while he transports his wares across town
- 11 Plague-ridden beggars want food and coin
- 12 A dead horse in the road, two men are failing to remove it
- 13 A young girl is selling oysters, will stab you if not paid well
- 14 A burly woman sells stolen goods under a bridge
- 15 A dog passes by with a severed hand with a signet ring in its mouth
- 16 The street ahead is barricaded with debris
- 17 A toothless man sells treasure maps, they look home-made
- 18 A pack of rabid dogs attacks viciously
- 19 A one-armed wizard cast random spells on strangers for practice and fun
- 20 A jealous, raging dwarf is chopping down the door of their lover's home

C. NIGHT TIME (SAFE AREA)

Inns and taverns come to life at night, and with them comes heavy drinking. This can lead to unpleasantries even in the safer parts of town.

D20 SAFE AREA

- 1 A couple of drunkards are arguing, wanting you to side with them
- 2 City guards are failing to help an old woman's cat out of a tree
- 3 A bride is crying outside the tent of a wedding ceremony
- 4 An elf is trying to sell an annoying, talking sword
- 5 There is a queue around the corner for entry to an exclusive club
- 6 A painter offers to paint caricatures of you
- 7 Heavy rain forces hundreds of rats into the open
- 8 Two young siblings sell fluorescent mushrooms from a sales booth
- 9 A young orphan wants to be your apprentice
- 10 The nearest inn is arranging a meat-eating contest
- 11 A pantomime starts mimicking one of you
- 12 A bartender throws a scrawny lute-player out in the street, the lute breaks
- 13 A small meteor falls from the sky and impacts two blocks away
- 14 A street corner prophet accuses you of bringing doom upon the city
- 15 A performer astounds with fire-acrobatics, while her partner picks pockets
- 16 A charismatic young man wants to recruit you to his cult
- 17 Townsfolk are flocking to a charming, newly opened inn serving wild boar
- 18 Four well-dressed men pass by, carrying a drunken groom
- 19 A young boy offers to shine shoes and patch holes, gladly sharing rumors.
- 20 A pale child sells bone-flutes made from human bones

D. NIGHT TIME (UNSAFE AREA)

Walking through unsafe areas at night is simply a bad idea, usually only done by the desperate or those with a death wish.

D20 UNSAFE AREA

- 1 A young woman gives out flyers for a new bar. The «bar» is a vampire coven
- 2 Someone was just stabbed close by, the murderer is running away
- 3 A brawl has broken out outside the closest inn
- 4 Someone is drowning in the river if not saved
- 5 Armored guards are clearing the street for their lords safety
- 6 Glowing eyes spy on you from a back alley
- 7 A group of seasoned dwarf warriors want to pick a fight
- 8 A drug dealer hands out free samples of a powerful new narcotic
- 9 A seemingly mad wizard is burning down a house
- 10 An armored knight offers you protection services
- 11 An old man twists on the ground in agony, changing into a werewolf
- 12 A dwarf and an elf are fighting over a treasure map, ripping it into pieces
- 13 Corrosive purple ooze is pouring out of an alchemist's shop
- 14 You are ambushed by tattooed bandits
- 15 A sly looking youngster is selling stolen goods, attacks and runs if provoked
- 16 A chatty rogue offers you work for the local mob
- 17 A street vendor sells suspicious meat
- 18 A shifty eyed stranger asks for directions to the illegal gambling hall
- 19 You hear your names whispered from an unusually dark back alley
- 20 Possessed ravens attacks you, controlled by a shadowy figure in the distance

E. OFF-SCREEN (POSITIVE)

Positive developments in a city are often the result of the players' actions. By recovering treasure, defeating dangerous foes, clearing dungeons, and driving off undead hordes, adventurers bring wealth, safety, and opportunity to the settlements around them. The results on this table do not have to be directly tied to the characters' deeds, but whenever possible, you should connect positive developments to their accomplishments. Doing so makes the city's growth feel earned and gives the players the satisfaction of seeing the world improve because of their actions.

D20 POSITIVE DEVELOPMENT

- 1 An heir to the ruler of the city has been born, the city is overjoyed
- 2 A new temple opens its doors, making healing cheaper due to increased competition
- 3 Weapon, armor and adventuring gear prices are reduced, for now
- 4 A wizard has finished brewing helpful potions for adventurers
- 5 A shipment of rare and exotic weapons just arrived at the market
- 6 A famous adventurer visits the city. Can share valuable advice and rumors
- 7 A large shipment of materials makes construction cheaper and faster
- 8 A new trade route is discovered, and they need someone to protect the caravans
- 9 The city guard has gained new leadership, and crime is down
- 10 A cartographer has donated his life's work to the adventurers' guild
- 11 A nearby dungeon has been discovered, and it's rumored to be filled with treasure
- 12 A festival brings great fortune and lifts spirits
- 13 A tournament is to be held in a few weeks, there's titles and prizes to be won
- 14 A political alliance strengthens the city
- 15 Spies have discovered a weak point in the enemy's defence
- 16 Skilled artisans settle in the city
- 17 A good harvest has driven the prices for food and drink down
- 18 A corrupt noble has been killed, and the wealth distributed to the people
- 19 A missing caravan returns with valuable wares
- 20 A royal wedding, and you're invited

F. OFF-SCREEN (NEGATIVE)

By the same token, it can be devastating to watch a city fall into decline because of the players' actions, or their failure to act. Negative developments tend to spur characters into action, assuming they are not too chaotic to care, and each result on this table can serve as a seed for adventure.

D20 NEGATIVE DEVELOPMENT

- 1 A fire has devastated a whole district in town, materials and manpower needed
- 2 A known ally of the party has been assassinated, a clue was left at the murder site
- 3 A factional power struggle has erupted in the city council, which side are you on?
- 4 A deadly plague has broken out, killing a large portion of the city's inhabitants
- 5 Due to a poor harvest, food and drink is more expensive than normal
- 6 A lack of materials has halted repairs and construction
- 7 Monster sightings in the streets make people more alert and cautious
- 8 The city watch becomes openly corrupt and vicious
- 9 A serial killer is on the loose, and no one dares walk the streets at night
- 10 The city's infrastructure has collapsed, and piles of trash are blocking the streets
- 11 Riots break out, they are demanding the heads of all nobles and their allies
- 12 The mines have run dry, and all weapon and armor prices are up for now
- 13 A temple with ulterior motives gains influence within politics
- 14 A powerful merchant vanishes under suspicious terms
- 15 A wizarding mishap has engulfed the city in an anti-magic mist
- 16 Trade routes are disrupted by decree or sabotage
- 17 A rival army is spotted near the borders, the city is preparing for a siege
- 18 A large-scale prison break has unleashed dangerous criminals into the streets
- 19 Emergency laws restrict city movement
- 20 A succession crisis throws the city into uncertainty





PRESENTS

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